REMOTE CAREER WORKBOOK

Remote Compensation and Offer Decision Workbook

A practical system for comparing employee, EOR, and contractor offers across cash, benefits, time, currency, contract risk, working reality, and career value.

Normalize what can be compared, keep uncertainty visible, stress-test the assumptions, and negotiate the few gaps that can change the decision.

VERSION 1.1

FORMAT GUIDE + WORKED EXAMPLES

STATUS LEARNER READY

REMOTE / COMPENSATION-AND-OFFER-DECISION

DECISION SYSTEM

Compare the whole offer, not the USD headline

A remote offer is a bundle of cash, benefits, working conditions, contract terms, currency exposure, and career options. This workbook makes each part visible before you decide or negotiate.

CORE IDEA

Use one comparison date, one currency anchor, and one set of assumptions. Separate verified facts from estimates so a precise-looking total never hides uncertainty.

01	02	03	04
Gate	**Normalize**	**Stress-test**	**Negotiate**
Remove any offer that fails a non-negotiable safety or work condition.	Put cash, benefits, costs, and time on the same annual basis.	Change the uncertain inputs and see whether the decision survives.	Ask for the few changes that can actually alter the result.

Write the decision before scoring

USE

Decision statement

By [date], choose the offer that best supports [12-24 month goal] while meeting [must-have conditions] and keeping [named risk] within an acceptable range.

CONTROL

Comparison boundary

Offers A and B, evaluated on the same date, with figures converted using the same planning rate and only written terms treated as facts.

Three evidence labels

Label	Meaning	How to record it
Verified	Written in the offer, benefits document, or contract.	Quote the clause or attach the source and date.
Estimated	A reasonable planning input that is not guaranteed.	Record the basis, range, owner, and next check.
Unknown	Material information is missing or ambiguous.	Turn it into a named employer or adviser question.

BOUNDARY

This workbook is educational. It does not determine employment status or provide tax, legal, investment, or currency advice. Use qualified India-specific advisers for personal conclusions.

STEP 1

Identify the engagement model

The same headline amount can produce very different obligations and protections. Confirm who employs or contracts with you, who pays you, and which promises are enforceable in writing.

Question	Direct employee	Employee through EOR	Independent contractor
Legal relationship	You are employed by the hiring entity or its local entity.	A local employer-of-record employs you and supplies services to the client.	You or your business supplies services under a commercial contract.
Pay evidence	Offer, payroll terms, payslip, and benefit documents.	Offer and local employment terms from the EOR; client promises should also be written.	Signed services agreement, statement of work, invoice terms, and payment method.
Time off	Confirm paid leave, holidays, and approval rules.	Confirm local policy, client policy, and which one controls.	Assume time off is unpaid unless the contract says otherwise.
Protection to verify	Notice, termination, benefits, probation, and policy coverage.	Employer identity, client assignment ending, transfer, notice, and benefit continuity.	Termination, notice, liability, IP, exclusivity, disputes, and invoice remedies.
Operating reality	Manager, review cycle, payroll, and working hours.	Split responsibilities between EOR and client; escalation path matters.	Deliverables, acceptance, availability, on-call, expenses, and scope changes.

Ask until the relationship is unambiguous

- [ ] What is the exact legal name and country of the entity signing with me?
- [ ] Am I an employee, an EOR employee, or an independent contractor in the written agreement?
- [ ] Who owns payroll or invoicing problems, benefits questions, performance management, and termination?
- [ ] What happens if the client ends its relationship with the EOR or changes providers?
- [ ] Which document controls if a recruiter message conflicts with the final agreement?

DO NOT INFER

A company laptop, full-time schedule, or monthly payment does not by itself answer the legal classification question. Record the written model and obtain qualified advice when the reality and paperwork appear inconsistent.

STEP 2

Normalize cash without false precision

Build an annual planning view, but keep guaranteed cash, probability-weighted cash, and speculative upside separate. Never add an uncertain promise to base pay as if both were equally reliable.

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Guaranteed annual cash = fixed pay + guaranteed allowances
Probable annual cash   = guaranteed cash + (target bonus x confidence)
Contractor planning cash = expected receipts - business costs - payment/FX costs
Planning INR value = USD cash x chosen planning rate
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Component	Record	Do not assume
Base or retainer	Currency, pay frequency, start date, review date, and any guaranteed minimum.	A monthly number always means twelve paid months or survives a pause.
Bonus or commission	Target, eligibility, measurement period, payout date, first-year proration, and history.	Target equals expected payout or is guaranteed.

Component	Record	Do not assume
Sign-on or retention	Vesting, repayment trigger, tax treatment to verify, and leaving date risk.	A one-time payment should be compared with recurring base.
Equity	Instrument, quantity, vesting, exercise rules, liquidity, expiry, and written valuation evidence.	An internal valuation is cash or a future sale is certain.
Overtime or on-call	Whether paid, expected frequency, rate, and time-off recovery.	Availability outside overlap hours is rare because the recruiter said so.

Confidence rule

HIGH CONFIDENCE

Guaranteed

Include at 100 percent only when the amount and condition are written and the condition is already satisfied.

UNCERTAIN

Variable

Use a range or explicit confidence such as 0, 50, and 100 percent. Keep it visible beside the total.

EQUITY RULE

Show equity as a separate scenario, not as salary. A useful decision can say Offer A wins on cash even if Offer B has uncertain upside.

STEP 3

Price benefits, unpaid time, and replacement costs

A contractor premium is not extra money until it covers the protections and costs that moved from the employer to you. Use your real replacement cost, not a generic percentage.

Area	Employee or EOR evidence	Contractor replacement question
Paid time off	Days, public holidays, sick leave, carryover, and first-year eligibility.	How many non-billable days will I reserve for leave, illness, holidays, and administration?
Health cover	People covered, limits, exclusions, waiting periods, and effective date.	What policy or emergency reserve would I buy for the same practical protection?
Retirement and insurance	Employer contributions and scheme documents; confirm actual eligibility.	What saving and protection must I fund independently?
Equipment and workspace	Laptop, repair, replacement, internet, coworking, and security requirements.	Which purchase, depreciation, support, or security cost remains mine?
Administration	Payroll, statutory records, and employer support path.	Accountant, invoicing, record keeping, banking, compliance review, and collection time.
Income continuity	Notice, severance or policy terms, and benefit end date to verify.	Bench reserve, delayed payment buffer, termination notice, and client concentration.

Convert unpaid days carefully

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Day-billed expected receipts = written day rate x expected paid days
If quoting full-capacity annual value: day rate = value / capacity days
Subtract non-billable days only if the starting value includes those days
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CHECK

Avoid double counting

If B is a guaranteed annual retainer paid regardless of leave, or USD90,000 already represents expected receipts after time off, do not subtract the same days again. Derive revenue from the written billing model before comparing.

CHECK

Value access, not labels

A benefit name has zero decision value until you confirm eligibility, coverage, start date, and practical use.

PERSONALIZE

Replacement cost depends on dependants, health needs, existing cover, savings, and risk tolerance. Record your source and range instead of copying someone else's contractor uplift.

STEP 4

Make currency and payment risk visible

Do not predict one exchange rate. Choose a documented planning rate, then test a stronger-rupee and weaker-rupee case while separating market movement from fees and payment failure.

01

Anchor

Record the source, timestamp, and rate used for the main comparison.

02

Range

Run at least three rates; treat them as sensitivity cases, not forecasts.

03

Friction

Separate provider spread, transfer fee, receiving fee, and conversion timing.

04

Control

Decide which party bears late-payment and currency-conversion choices.

FICTIONAL WORKED EXAMPLE - ADAPT THE METHOD, NOT THE FACTS

Scenario	USD annual cash	Planning rate	Gross INR view	What it tests
Stronger INR	USD 72,000	INR 80 / USD	INR 5,760,000	Lower rupee value for the same USD cash.
Planning	USD 72,000	INR 85 / USD	INR 6,120,000	Common illustrative anchor; not a current market quote.
Weaker INR	USD 72,000	INR 90 / USD	INR 6,480,000	Upside scenario, not guaranteed income.

These hypothetical rates apply only to USD-exposed cash. Offer A's fixed INR payroll does not move with this sensitivity; its USD equivalent is only a comparison anchor.

Payment-path checklist

- ☐ Invoice currency, due date, acceptance condition, and late-payment remedy are written.
- ☐ Transfer platform, bank fees, FX spread, intermediary deductions, and who pays each cost are known.
- ☐ A small test payment confirms beneficiary details before a material invoice is due.
- ☐ You know what evidence the bank, accountant, or adviser needs you to retain.
- ☐ A buffer covers at least one realistic delay; the comparison records the chosen buffer, not a universal rule.

KEEP TWO RISKS SEPARATE

Exchange-rate movement changes the INR value of valid payment. Payment risk is the chance that money arrives late, short, disputed, or not at all. They need different controls.

STEP 5

Compare the operating reality

A high-paying role can be a poor offer if the written schedule, on-call burden, decision access, or manager relationship makes the work unsustainable. Score the actual operating system, not the remote label.

Dimension	Evidence to request	Decision question
Time-zone overlap	Named hours, daylight-saving impact, meeting distribution, and escalation exceptions.	How often will work cross my protected hours, and who can change the expectation?
On-call and incidents	Rotation size, pages, severity, compensation or recovery, and backup coverage.	What does a bad week look like, and how often does it occur?
Leave in practice	Approval path, blackout periods, team coverage, and actual use.	Can I use the stated leave without creating an invisible performance penalty?
Manager and feedback	Reporting line, review cadence, first 90-day outcomes, and promotion ownership.	Who decides whether I am succeeding, and what evidence will they use?
Scope and learning	First projects, decision authority, technical surface, mentorship, and roadmap access.	Will this role produce stronger evidence for my next target?
Remote support	Equipment, security, travel, coworking, communication norms, and local escalation.	Which failure or expense becomes mine because I am remote?

Turn vague promises into observable terms

PROMISE

Vague

Flexible hours, strong growth, generous equity, global team, and unlimited leave.

EVIDENCE

Observable

Three overlap hours, monthly career review, written grant terms, six-person rotation, and named equipment budget.

CAREER VALUE

Do not force career value into rupees. Score it separately using evidence: scope you will own, decisions you can make, systems you will touch, feedback quality, and the stories you can later defend.

STEP 6

Inspect the contract and compliance questions

Your job is not to become a lawyer or tax adviser. Your job is to spot terms that can change value or risk, record the uncertainty, and route the exact question to the right owner.

Term	What to locate	Question to ask
Payment	Amount, currency, invoice trigger, due date, acceptance, expenses, withholding, and dispute path.	What event starts the payment clock, and what happens if payment is late or short?
Termination	Notice for each side, immediate triggers, pay through notice, final invoice, and benefit end date.	Which amounts survive termination, and can the client end an EOR assignment without the same notice?
IP and confidentiality	Background IP, work product, open source, side projects, inventions, and confidentiality duration.	Does the language reach work created outside the engagement or tools I already own?
Liability and indemnity	Caps, exclusions, insurance expectations, data/security obligations, and defence control.	Is my downside bounded and proportionate to the fees and control I have?
Exclusivity and restrictions	Other clients, moonlighting, non-solicit, non-compete, geography, and duration.	Which real future work would this prevent?
Law and disputes	Governing law, venue, arbitration, language, costs, and notice method.	How would I practically enforce or defend this term from India?

Route the question

Owner	Best used for
Employer or recruiter	Missing package facts, policy documents, operating expectations, and written amendments.
Qualified legal adviser	Classification, enforceability, IP, liability, restrictions, governing law, and disputes.
Qualified tax or accounting adviser	Personal tax, GST, invoicing, withholding, records, deductions, and entity choices.
Bank or authorized payment provider	Receiving requirements, fees, conversion, remittance evidence, and payment tracing.

RED FLAG

A promise is not resolved because someone says it is standard. Ask where it appears in the document and whether an authorized person can amend the term in writing.

STEP 7

Use gates before weights

A weighted score can make an unacceptable offer look attractive. Remove or escalate any offer that fails a must-have condition before assigning preference weights.

Worked must-have checks

FICTIONAL WORKED EXAMPLE - ADAPT THE METHOD, NOT THE FACTS

Must-have condition	Evidence or clause	A	B	Action if unclear
Legal engagement and payer are clear	A: local EOR contract. B: services agreement and named payer.	Pass	Pass	Verify entity, authority, and payment owner before signing.
Minimum cash and pay timing	A: USD72k equivalent on written INR payroll. B: day-rate capacity; no annual minimum.	Pass	Review	Confirm billable-day basis and payment trigger, not headline alone.
Sustainable overlap and on-call	A: three protected hours. B: five hours and unclear incident availability.	Pass	Hold	Require a written sustainable schedule and escalation boundary.
Acceptable termination and downside	A: verified notice. B: 14-day termination.	Pass	Hold	Request longer notice or a funded exit buffer acceptable to the learner.
IP and restrictions acceptable	A: review complete in this fictional case. B: background-IP clause unresolved.	Pass	Hold	Route clause to qualified adviser; do not let a high score override it.

Provisional preference comparison

FICTIONAL WORKED EXAMPLE - ADAPT THE METHOD, NOT THE FACTS

Dimension	Weight 1-5	Offer A 1-5	Offer B 1-5	Evidence and confidence
Normalized cash	5	3	3	A72k vs B72.6k in 30-day base case: near tie, not B headline win. Medium confidence.
Benefit certainty / access	3	4	2	Coverage access, eligibility and continuity: A verified; B policy not secured. Cost is already in cash. Medium.
Operating sustainability	5	4	2	Three protected versus five unclear overlap hours. B cannot pass gate yet.
Contract / payment risk	5	4	2	B short notice and no annual minimum; source is sample contract terms.
Role scope / career value	3	3	4	B architecture scope attractive; manager and review path still unconfirmed. Low.

Multiply each rating by its weight and add: A = 76/105; B = 53/105 (maximum 5 x 21). These are subjective preferences, not probabilities or market benchmarks. Cash already deducts B's estimated benefit replacement cost; the benefit row assesses access and certainty, not that cost twice. B's unresolved gates still prevent acceptance regardless of its score.

SCORING RULE

Write the evidence before the score. If two offers are within the uncertainty range, call the result close and prioritize the missing facts instead of pretending the decimal total decides.

WORKED EXAMPLE

Calculate the difference, then test what could reverse it

Fictional A is a USD72,000-equivalent EOR salary. B is USD90,000 gross capacity at 260 day-billed days, not a guaranteed retainer. All amounts below are before personal tax and FX; A benefits are considered separately.

Input	Offer A: EOR employee	Offer B: contractor
Written fixed cash	USD 72,000 equivalent on fixed INR payroll in this example	USD 90,000 capacity at 260 day-billed days; no guaranteed minimum
Paid time	20 leave days plus stated holidays	No paid time; learner plans 30 non-billable days
Benefits	Medical cover and employer retirement contribution; eligibility verified	Learner estimates USD 4,000 replacement cost
Business and payment cost	No separate estimate	USD 3,000 administration, tools, and payment friction
Termination	Written notice; terms verified	Client may terminate in 14 days
Working hours	Three protected overlap hours	Five overlap hours plus an unclear incident expectation
Career evidence	Clear ownership of one service	Broader architecture scope, but manager and review path unclear

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B day rate = 90,000 / 260 = USD 346.1538
30 non-billable days = 30 x 346.1538 = USD 10,384.62
B base = 90,000 - 10,384.62 - 4,000 - 3,000 = USD 72,615.38
A fixed salary = USD 72,000 equivalent; B cash difference = USD 615.38
45 non-billable days: B = 90,000 - 15,576.92 - 7,000 = USD 67,423.08
Stress-case B minus A = -USD 4,576.92
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PROVISIONAL

Base case

The apparent USD18,000 headline premium shrinks to USD615 after the stated unpaid days and replacement costs. Treat this as close: small estimate changes outweigh the difference. B remains on hold while schedule, termination, and IP questions are unresolved.

SENSITIVITY

Stress case

At 45 non-billable days, B falls below A on this planning cash view. This is a sensitivity assumption, not a prediction. A payment delay changes liquidity and buffer needs; do not count it as lost income unless there is an actual loss assumption.

LESSON

The correct output is not EOR always wins or contractor always wins. It is: here is the current choice, the assumptions holding it up, and the exact fact that could reverse it.

STEP 8

Negotiate the gap that changes the decision

Do not send a list of everything that could improve. Use the comparison to identify one to three gaps, explain why they matter, and propose alternatives the employer can actually approve.

Gap	Evidence	Primary ask	Possible trade
Contractor carries benefit and leave cost	Replacement-cost worksheet	Higher fixed fee or paid closure days	Longer commitment or defined delivery scope
Currency or fee uncertainty	Payment-path and scenario check	USD denomination, fee coverage, or clearer conversion rule	Different payment schedule
Termination downside	Notice and continuity comparison	Longer notice or termination payment	Shorter initial term with mutual review
Overlap burden	Written calendar and team evidence	Protected hours or rotating late meetings	A smaller fixed overlap window
Cash gap	Normalized guaranteed-cash comparison	Base, sign-on, or guaranteed first-year component	Title, start date, or review checkpoint if cash is fixed

Worked negotiation priorities

FICTIONAL WORKED EXAMPLE - ADAPT THE METHOD, NOT THE FACTS

Priority	Target	Evidence-based rationale	Fallback	Walk-away boundary
1: hours	Three protected overlap hours	Five hours plus undefined incidents exceeds this fictional learner's sustainable schedule.	Rotating late meeting plus a defined incident rota.	No open-ended daily availability.
2: continuity	30-day notice or equivalent termination payment	14 days is below this learner's planned transition buffer.	Short initial term with funded notice on early exit.	No unbounded interruption without a realistic cash buffer.
3: package	Higher day rate or paid closure days	At 30 unpaid days, B normalizes to USD72,615 before personal tax; premium over A nearly disappears.	Contracted minimum billable days or explicit paid closure allowance.	Do not count non-guaranteed work as annual guaranteed cash.

TALK TRACK

Fictional negotiation: I am interested in owning the architecture work. Five overlap hours plus an undefined incident window is not sustainable for me. Could we agree on three protected hours and a written incident rota? A rotating late meeting could be an alternative.

COMPLETED COMPARISON

Read the whole offer on one evidence page

This fictional comparison carries the same A and B offers through cash, costs, risk, working reality, and uncertainty. It is an example of method, not a recommended offer or personal advice.

FICTIONAL WORKED EXAMPLE - ADAPT THE METHOD, NOT THE FACTS

Decision input	Offer A	Offer B	Source / confidence / next check
Engagement / signing entity	Local EOR employee; written model verified.	Independent contractor; named services-agreement payer.	Fictional contracts; verify classification for real facts.
Annual cash basis	USD72,000 equivalent on fixed local payroll.	USD90,000 gross capacity at 260 day-billed days; not a guarantee.	Offer and rate schedule; confirm minimum billable days.
Variable cash	No bonus counted in example.	No bonus counted in example.	Keep any real target payout separate from fixed cash.
Equity	Excluded from cash comparison.	Excluded from cash comparison.	If offered, obtain grant terms and model separately.
Time / replacement cost	20 paid leave days; eligibility verified.	30 non-billable days + USD4k benefits + USD3k operating costs.	B estimates; collect quotes and avoid subtracting leave twice.
FX / payment cases	INR payroll fixed by written offer; USD figure is comparison anchor.	USD invoices exposed to conversion and collection delay.	Use actual payment terms; hypothetical rates are not forecasts.
Termination / contract	Notice terms verified in this example.	14-day exit and unresolved background-IP clause.	B on hold pending written terms and qualified review.
Hours / sustainability	Three protected overlap hours.	Five hours plus unclear incident expectation.	Written rota and exception policy needed for B.
Scope / career evidence	Own one service; manager and review path clear.	Broader architecture scope; review path uncertain.	Ask for first-90-day decisions and success evidence.

PROVISIONAL DECISION

In this fictional case A is provisionally preferred for predictable cash and working hours. Reopen B only after its schedule and contract gates clear and its normalized package remains stronger under realistic time-off assumptions.

DECISION MEMO

Close with evidence, uncertainty, and action

A useful decision memo is short enough to reread before signing and specific enough to show what you verified, what remains uncertain, and why the choice still makes sense.

FICTIONAL WORKED EXAMPLE - ADAPT THE METHOD, NOT THE FACTS

Memo field	Completed example
Decision	In this fictional comparison, choose A provisionally; do not accept B while its must-have schedule and contract questions remain unresolved.
Why	A has a written salary, verified operating boundary, and clear manager. B's normalized base-case cash advantage is only USD615 before personal tax and FX.
Trade-off accepted	Accept narrower architecture scope in exchange for a more predictable operating and payment arrangement; seek growth evidence in the first-90-day plan.
Uncertainty	B's 30 non-billable days, USD4k benefit replacement, and USD3k operating cost are estimates. At 45 days its planning cash falls below A.
Reversal condition	Reopen B if sustainable hours, acceptable exit/IP terms, a clear manager, and a reliably higher normalized package are documented. A higher headline alone is insufficient.
Next action	Before a real decision, obtain final authorized documents, current cost quotes, and qualified advice on personal tax, classification, and contract implications.

Before you sign

- [ ] The signing entity, engagement model, payment path, start date, and first payment date agree across documents.
- [ ] Every negotiated change appears in the final written offer, contract, or authorized amendment.
- [ ] A qualified adviser has reviewed the personal legal, tax, GST, or classification questions you identified.
- [ ] You retained the offer, policy documents, contract version, written answers, calculations, sources, and comparison date.
- [ ] You reread termination, IP, liability, restrictions, governing law, confidentiality, and dispute terms in the final version.
- [ ] You know the first-week contacts for manager, HR or EOR, payroll or invoicing, security, and equipment support.

ACTION

Choose one real offer or two fictional offers. Complete the evidence labels first, run three sensitivity cases, write the reversal condition, and only then draft the negotiation ask.

SOURCE DISCIPLINE

Verify dated and personal questions at the source

The framework is durable; tax rules, forms, benefits, payment methods, fees, and contract effects can change. Use the official starting points below and obtain advice for your facts.

Starting point	Use it to verify	Official URL
Income Tax Department	Current forms, filing services, tax calendar, AIS, and official help material.	https://www.incometax.gov.in/
GST portal	Current registration, returns, taxpayer services, notifications, and official learning resources.	https://www.gst.gov.in/
Reserve Bank of India	Official foreign-exchange information and regulated banking or remittance guidance.	https://www.rbi.org.in/
Employees' Provident Fund Organisation	Current scheme information and member or employer services where relevant.	https://www.epfindia.gov.in/

Record the evidence, not only the link

- ☐ Source title, publisher, URL or document name, and the date you checked it.
- ☐ The exact question the source answers and the part that still needs interpretation.
- ☐ The qualified adviser or employer owner responsible for applying it to your situation.
- ☐ A refresh date for any figure, fee, rule, policy, or market-dependent assumption.

Quick recap

01	02	03	04
Facts	**Value**	**Risk**	**Choice**
Treat only written, current terms as verified.	Normalize cash and replacement costs without hiding ranges.	Stress-test currency, payment, contract, and operating assumptions.	Name the decision, trade-off, reversal condition, and next action.

FINAL TAKEAWAY

The best offer is not the one with the largest converted number. It is the one whose verified value, working reality, downside, and career path best fit your decision boundary - and whose uncertainty you can explain honestly.

APPLY THE METHOD TO YOUR OWN EVIDENCE

Using actual written offers: label every input verified, estimated, or unknown; normalize cash on a stated billing basis; run a time-off and FX sensitivity; resolve must-have gates; then write the decision and what would reverse it.